Paragate — Narrative Kinematics Report

Generated from manuscript ADTM data using the StoryNK model. M = Magnitude / premise alignment (legacy V / Vector).

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Story	Units	Position Span
Paragate	53	571 - 56,806

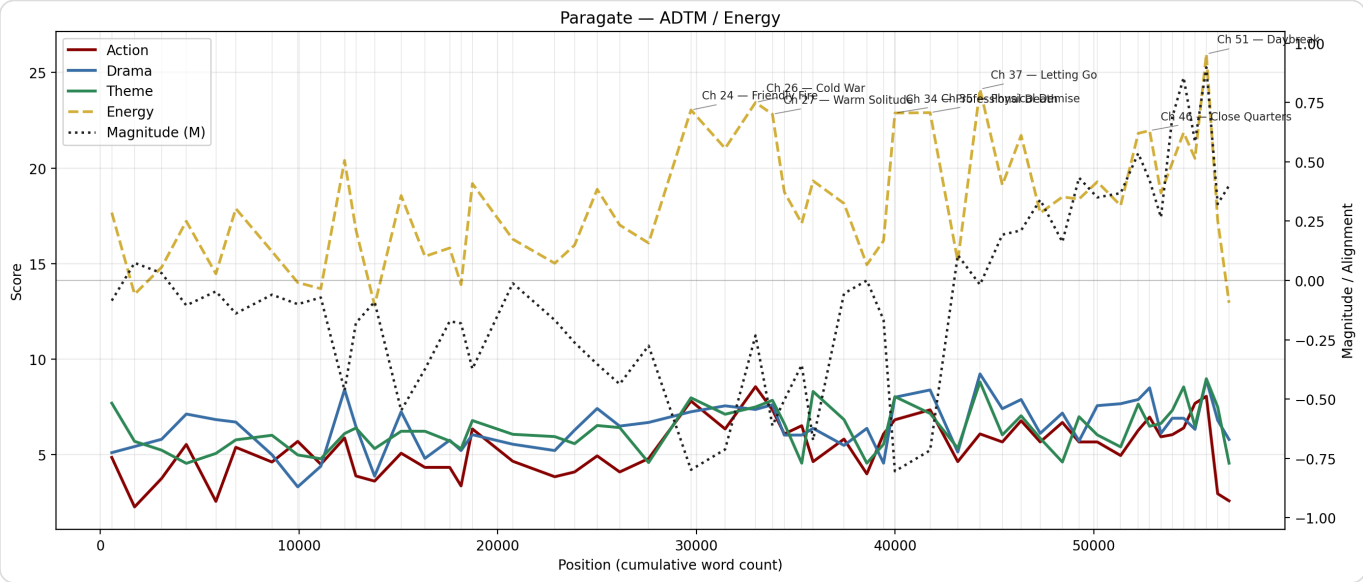
Mean Energy	Mean Magnitude	Mean Premise Force
18.20	-0.055	-0.34

Peak Energy: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Peak Gravity: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Peak Premise Load: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Highest Cut Risk: Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

System Overview

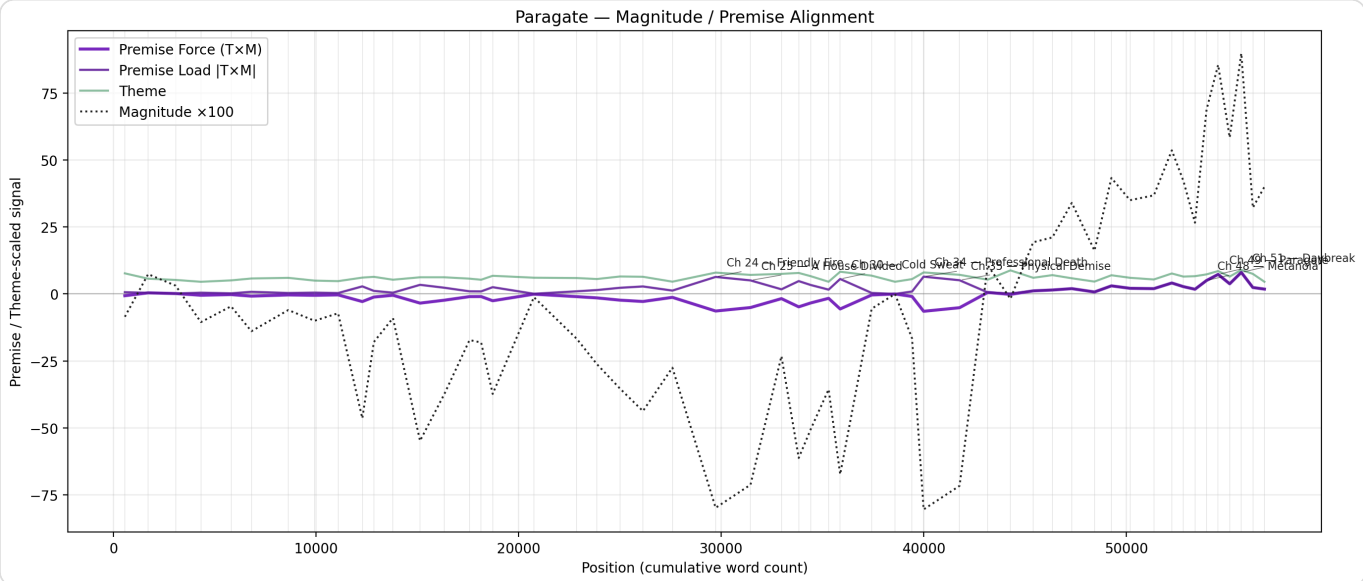
Action, Drama, and Theme define the primary narrative magnitude fields. Magnitude (M) tracks premise alignment, with negative values leaning toward anti-truth and positive values leaning toward governing truth. Energy is A + D + T. Premise Force is T × M. Steady-state and transient tracks approximate long-wave baseline versus local fluctuation. Narrative Mass, Peak Prominence, and Narrative Gravity estimate which regions are merely loud versus which ones are actually load-bearing.

ADTM / Energy Landscape

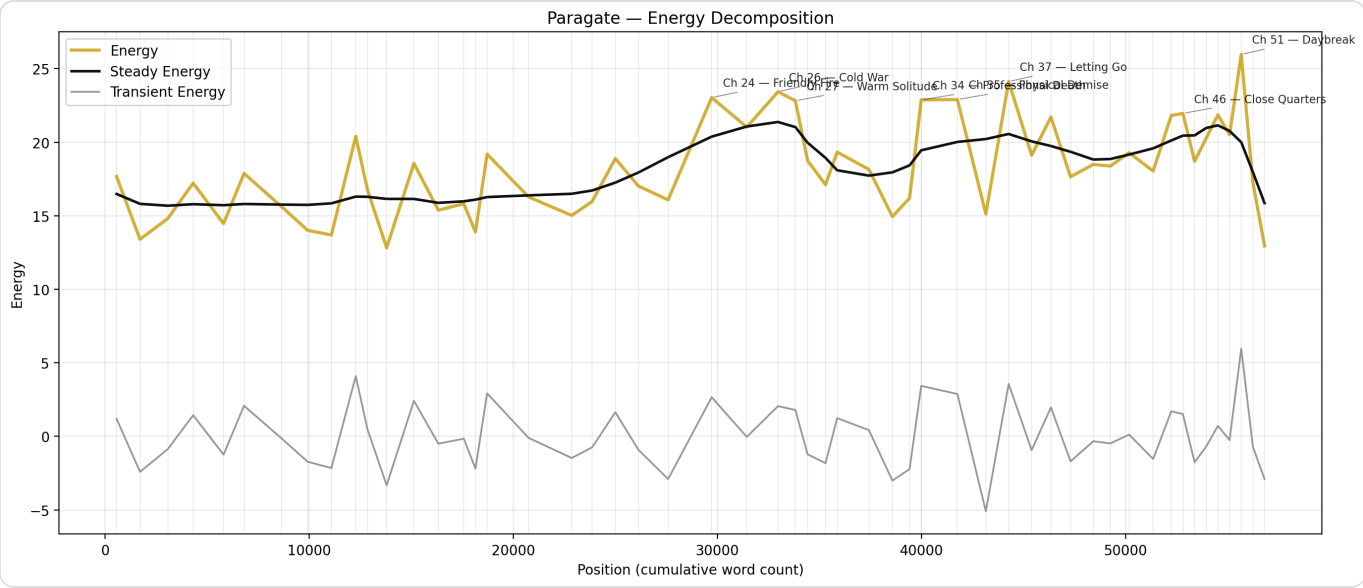


Action, Drama, Theme, Energy, and Magnitude across cumulative story position.

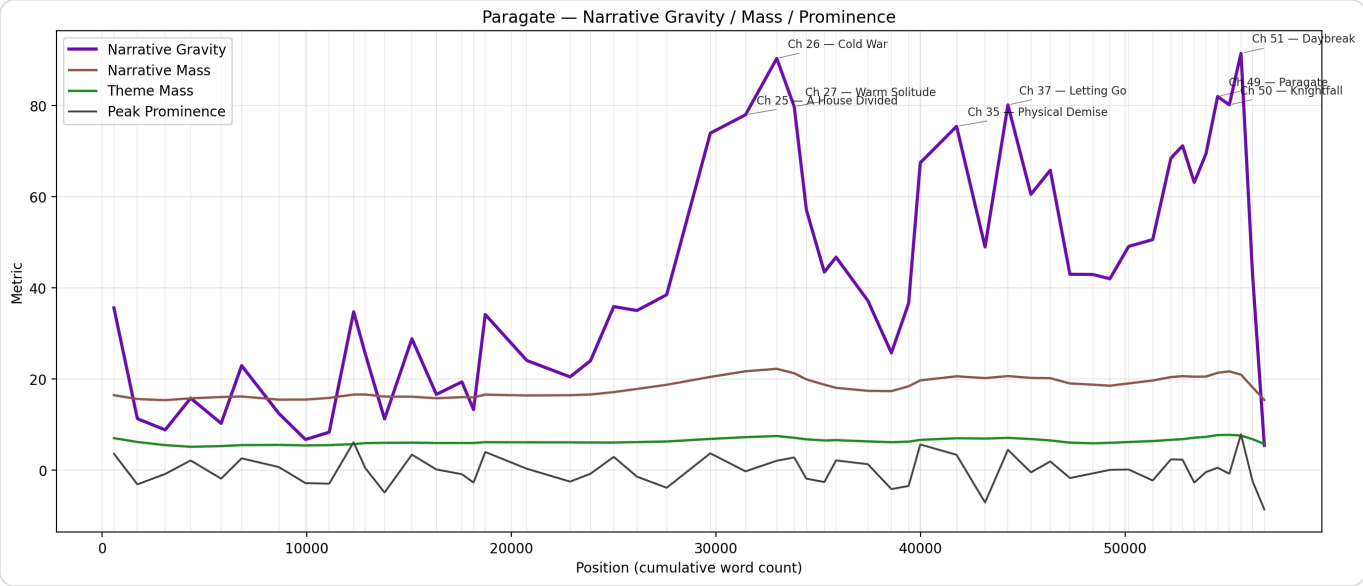
Magnitude / Premise Alignment



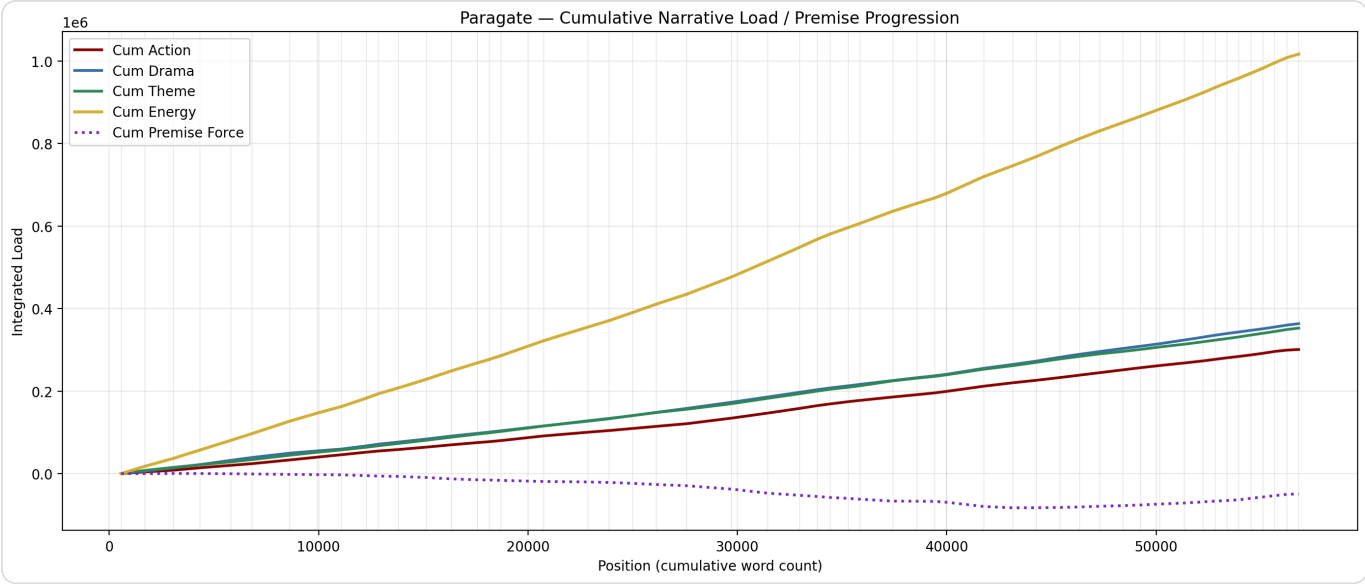
Magnitude, Premise Force (T×M), and Premise Load |T×M| across the manuscript.



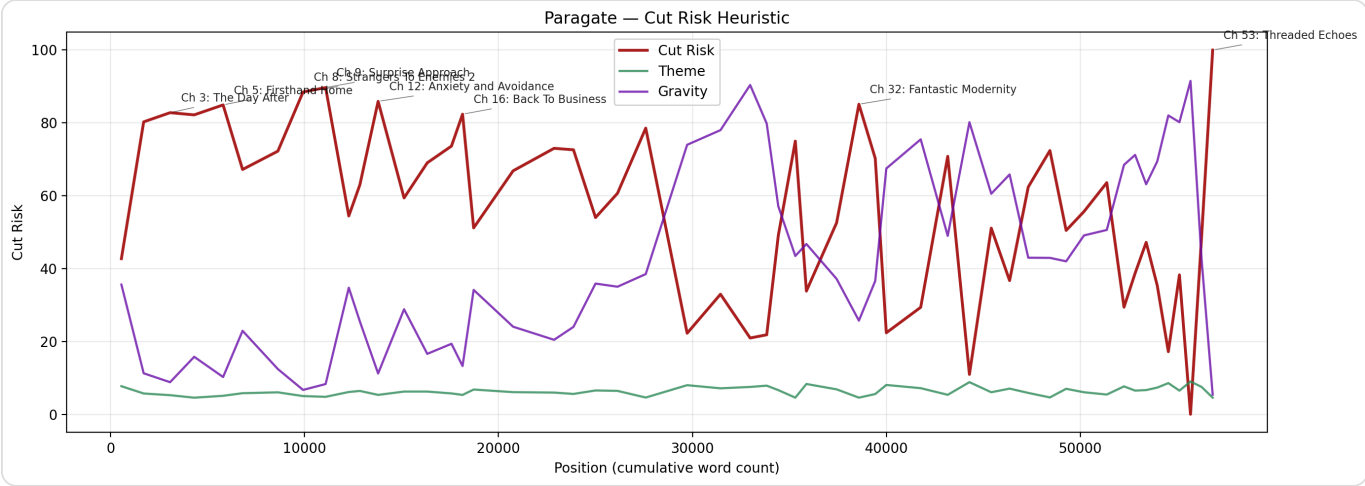
Composite Energy versus steady-state and transient energy behavior.



Narrative Gravity, Mass, Theme Mass, and Peak Prominence.



Cumulative action, drama, theme, energy, and premise progression.



Cut-risk heuristic versus theme and gravity.

Top Gravity Peaks

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Gravity: 91.45 | **Energy:** 25.97 | **M:** +0.90 | **PF:** +8.06 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 26 — Cold War

Gravity: 90.32 | **Energy:** 23.43 | **M:** -0.23 | **PF:** -1.74 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified | 2015-10-03

Summary: Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.

Blurb: Years earlier, in a storm of ice and static, a mission hangs by a thread.

It's the cold snap that brings him back again.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Gravity: 81.98 | **Energy:** 21.86 | **M:** +0.85 | **PF:** +7.31 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.

Blurb: Once the truth is seen with open eyes, the only question left is whether anyone can move fast enough.

Katiya brings Aldrin face-to-face with the reality of the approaching threat, and Jade and Aliaki reinforce what she has forced him to witness. When the Royal Knights arrive, Aldri...

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Gravity: 80.13 | **Energy:** 20.51 | **M:** +0.58 | **PF:** +3.79 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the

real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.

Blurb: Winter arrives with teeth just when the defenses start to hold.

Watching the drone feed, Cody spots enemy figures crossing the lake and realizes the defenses are no longer where they need to be. When comms fail, he leaves the drone idling and r...

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Gravity: 80.12 | **Energy:** 24.13 | **M:** -0.02 | **PF:** -0.16 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | Unspecified | 2026-12-01

Summary:

Blurb: Shame, buried memories, and unexpected visitors push both worlds toward a new kind of war.

"She was trying to save him," Jullian says. "Bertram left and we did nothing — but it was Katiya that was braver than all of us!"

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Gravity: 79.76 | **Energy:** 22.82 | **M:** -0.61 | **PF:** -4.80 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | The Shortwall | 2005-08-23

Summary: Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.

Blurb: Long before today, a childhood dare turned into a scar that never closed.

"Why is it so hard for you to let go?" The question comes from thirty feet below.

Ch 25 — A House Divided

Gravity: 77.95 | **Energy:** 21.03 | **M:** -0.71 | **PF:** -5.07 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-07-07

Summary: Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.

Blurb: Back at the house, two people who need comfort get conflict instead.

Sometimes this numbness can be a blessing in the same way that it's a curse.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Gravity: 75.42 | **Energy:** 22.90 | **M:** -0.72 | **PF:** -5.13 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Top Energy Peaks

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Energy: 25.97 | **Energy:** 25.97 | **M:** +0.90 | **PF:** +8.06 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Energy: 24.13 | **Energy:** 24.13 | **M:** -0.02 | **PF:** -0.16 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | Unspecified | 2026-12-01

Summary:

Blurb: Shame, buried memories, and unexpected visitors push both worlds toward a new kind of war.

"She was trying to save him," Jullian says. "Bertram left and we did nothing — but it was Katiya that was braver than all of us!"

Ch 26 — Cold War

Energy: 23.43 | **Energy:** 23.43 | **M:** -0.23 | **PF:** -1.74 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified | 2015-10-03

Summary: Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.

Blurb: Years earlier, in a storm of ice and static, a mission hangs by a thread.

It's the cold snap that brings him back again.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Energy: 23.04 | **Energy:** 23.04 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.37 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-07-07

Summary: Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.

Blurb: One wins the crowd; the other loses control. Lines are drawn on both sides.

Reed's entirely prepared as he advances towards his last slide. In the lower corner, it reads 20 OF 20: even with a custom progress bar to show the stages of his presentation.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Energy: 22.90 | **Energy:** 22.90 | **M:** -0.72 | **PF:** -5.13 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Energy: 22.88 | **Energy:** 22.88 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.46 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: At work, a meeting becomes a reckoning. Someone steps forward, and the cost is real.

When I rose from four hours of sleep, I found that same feeling of dread I found in college when the world finally caught up with me, when I remembered it was a heavy day of finals...

Largest Premise Loads

Ch 51 — Daybreak

PremiseLoad: 8.06 | **Energy:** 25.97 | **M:** +0.90 | **PF:** +8.06 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 49 — Paragate

PremiseLoad: 7.31 | **Energy:** 21.86 | **M:** +0.85 | **PF:** +7.31 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.

Blurb: Once the truth is seen with open eyes, the only question left is whether anyone can move fast enough.

Katiya brings Aldrin face-to-face with the reality of the approaching threat, and Jade and Aliaki reinforce what she has forced him to witness. When the Royal Knights arrive, Aldri...

Ch 34 — Professional Death

PremiseLoad: 6.46 | **Energy:** 22.88 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.46 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: At work, a meeting becomes a reckoning. Someone steps forward, and the cost is real.

When I rose from four hours of sleep, I found that same feeling of dread I found in college when the world finally caught up with me, when I remembered it was a heavy day of finals...

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

PremiseLoad: 6.37 | **Energy:** 23.04 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.37 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-07-07

Summary: Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in

Gaffesend.

Blurb: One wins the crowd; the other loses control. Lines are drawn on both sides.

Reed's entirely prepared as he advances towards his last slide. In the lower corner, it reads 20 OF 20: even with a custom progress bar to show the stages of his presentation.

Ch 30 — Cold Sweat

PremiseLoad: 5.59 | **Energy:** 19.33 | **M:** -0.67 | **PF:** -5.59 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Lake Garrison | 2026-11-27

Summary:

Blurb: New alliances form while an ominous email threatens Cody's career.

They say to never challenge an Ahkvasan to a foot race: you might be faster, but you still won't get there in time.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

PremiseLoad: 5.13 | **Energy:** 22.90 | **M:** -0.72 | **PF:** -5.13 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Ch 25 — A House Divided

PremiseLoad: 5.07 | **Energy:** 21.03 | **M:** -0.71 | **PF:** -5.07 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-07-07

Summary: Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.

Blurb: Back at the house, two people who need comfort get conflict instead.

Sometimes this numbness can be a blessing in the same way that it's a curse.

Ch 48 — Metanoia

PremiseLoad: 5.04 | **Energy:** 20.28 | **M:** +0.69 | **PF:** +5.04 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Both protagonists fight for one clean chance to be heard. Cody's confession turns his firing into a political problem inside Navidson-Monroe, while Katiya persuades Aryn that the truth matters more than procedure and turns imprisonment into a joint push toward Aldrin. The chapter tests what they have actually learned: not how to escape pressure, but how to move through it without lying to themselves.

Blurb: Some doors open because you're invited. The important ones never do.

Cody is pulled into a glass conference room where HR tries to reduce him to a clean termination case, with Reed present as witness. Cody refuses to sign, clears his father, and for...

Highest Cut-Risk Units

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

CutRisk: 99.91 | **Energy:** 12.95 | **M:** +0.40 | **PF:** +1.82 | **POV:** Default

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary:

Blurb: Titus' past catches up with him.

In the only Titus-perspective scene of the book, Ellie reveals a memory, gesture, or contradiction that should not be possible. The moment leaves Titus with the terrible understand...

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

CutRisk: 89.63 | **Energy:** 13.69 | **M:** -0.07 | **PF:** -0.34 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-26

Summary: Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.

Blurb: Cody barricades more than a door as reality refuses to make sense.

Late Sunday morning, around 11:00, I awoke with my neck twisted against the closet door, my face saturated with drool, shirt missing, and a sticky note taped to my forehead with Mi...

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

CutRisk: 88.42 | **Energy:** 14.01 | **M:** -0.10 | **PF:** -0.50 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-04-25

Summary: Third clash: Katiya (assuming Auvryan assassin) and Cody fight to another misunderstanding; she drives him back through the door.

Blurb: Misread motives turn their encounter into a full-on clash.

I wager my strength and power over his defenses. The inebriated man called Cody holds the odd, metallic broomstick with his hands together in the center — a technique I've never se...

Ch 12 — Anxiety and Avoidance

CutRisk: 85.85 | **Energy:** 12.82 | **M:** -0.09 | **PF:** -0.48 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-05-22

Summary: FOUR WEEK TIME SKIPKatiya, Ryder, and Paxton rescue near-dead Bertram; she's blamed and shut out—her only remaining lifeline is Cody.

Blurb: With help scarce, Katiya runs toward the only lifeline left.

Calling his name will do nothing. I decide ahead of time to break in instead of patiently knocking, hoping the others piece together my purpose for panic instead of thinking I'm ju...

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

CutRisk: 85.05 | **Energy:** 14.94 | **M:** +0.00 | **PF:** +0.00 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody
Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-11-29

Summary:

Blurb: Katiya's first peaceful sleep leads straight into chaotic, sword-filled "fantasy" tourism on Earth.

Even in another world, I can't escape the same dream. The only difference is that sleep comes faster on a bed that's made of clouds, instead of one made from horsehair and feathers...

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

CutRisk: 84.87 | **Energy:** 14.47 | **M:** -0.05 | **PF:** -0.23 | **POV:** Cody
Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.

Blurb: Drinks with a best friend turn into confessions—and an idea Cody should ignore.

"Since you started on your first day, you haven't been drug tested. What's gonna change their mind on Monday, bro? My work never runs drug tests," he says. Gunfire cracks over the...

Ch 3 — The Day After

CutRisk: 82.74 | **Energy:** 14.81 | **M:** +0.03 | **PF:** +0.16 | **POV:** Cody
Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.

Blurb: Another soul-numbing office day pushes Cody toward a choice he's not ready to make.

I realize I'm done working on the redline when my hands stop moving. Copying changes from a red-inked engineering drawing to the computer is easy enough to get lost in thought. The...

Ch 16 — Back To Business

CutRisk: 82.33 | **Energy:** 13.90 | **M:** -0.18 | **PF:** -0.96 | **POV:** Cody
Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-05-25

Summary: Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he returns hoping for an open door.

Blurb: A lunch with Dad. A memory of a brother. A door that might be open tonight.

"I think that will work just fine," Reed says. "What do you think?"

LLM Revision Diagnosis

Length assessment: 53 chapters is viable for a dual-protagonist "double novel," but the current generative draft reads over-distributed in the first half and middle. The back third has real structural mass; the opening and several mirrored mid-book runs look too granular for the amount of premise movement they deliver.
Structural health: Structurally, the novel is strongest from late Act Three into the Act Four climax. The mountain is real: Chapters 34-35 hit hard on the negative side, Chapter 37 acts as a hinge, Chapters 45-51 build with increasing positive alignment, and Chapter 51 is the unquestionable summit by energy, gravity, and premise force. Earlier sections show valleying, low prominence, and repeated local beats that do not always compound.
Premise alignment: Premise alignment is mixed but promising. The manuscript spends much of its mean magnitude slightly negative, which fits a long failure/descent phase, but too many chapters with decent theme sit near zero or weak alignment, suggesting uncertainty about what the story is "about" in motion. When the book commits—24, 25, 27, 30, 34, 35 on the descent side; 45, 48, 49, 51 on the ascent side—it becomes much sharper.
Distribution health: Energy and gravity are back-loaded. Act One has hook value but also the highest concentration of cut-risk and cheapness. Act Three contains both some of the book's best material and a drag pocket around the Earth/fantasy-tourism sequence. Act Four is the cleanest sustained run, though a few planning-and-bonding chapters repeat similar dual-protagonist functions. The Titus bonus chapter lands after emotional closure and currently behaves like detachable promo matter rather than integral epilogue.
Primary strength: The story's biggest strength is that its major trauma/reckoning chapters are not merely loud—they are premise-bearing. Katiya's arc in particular culminates in a structurally legitimate climax, and the dual-protagonist braid becomes most effective when both lines convert private damage into public action.
Primary risk: The biggest risk is mirrored-beat drag: the dual-novel gimmick sometimes produces paired scenes that echo each other without escalating the central premise. This is most visible in the early misunderstanding loop, the mid-book relationship/outing material, and some Act Four planning-grief-household chapters where emotional intent is clear but thematic vector is diluted.

Paragate has a real novel inside it already, and the metrics strongly support that the true book emerges in the late-middle through climax rather than in the current opening sprawl. The strongest spine is: descent through public/private failure, excavation of formative trauma, reversal into chosen truth and joint action, then Katiya's dawn confrontation. Revision should not flatten the double-novel concept, but it should get much harsher about asking whether each mirrored Cody/Katiya beat creates new vector or merely reflects prior material. Compress the early loop, tighten the Act Three tourism/romance drift, protect the trauma-and-reckoning core, and treat the Titus add-on as explicitly bonus material unless it can be made to pay rent for the main book.

Protect at All Costs

- Chapter 24
- Chapter 27
- Chapter 34
- Chapter 35
- Chapter 37
- Chapter 45
- Chapter 48
- Chapter 49
- Chapter 51

Strongest Regions

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Reason: This is the clear structural summit: peak energy, peak gravity, peak premise force, zero cheapness flags, and the summary describes true arc completion rather than generic spectacle.
Revision instruction: Protect the chapter's core design. Revision should focus on setup and clarity, not expansion: make sure every key image, fear trigger, and choice has been planted earlier so the climax feels inevitable rather than merely intense.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Reason: This appears to be the story's cleanest premise-forward pivot into endgame, with very high theme, very high positive magnitude, low ambiguity, and low cheapness.
Revision instruction: Sharpen this as the point of no return. Make the witnesses, decisions, and role-acceptance beats unmistakably irreversible.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Reason: A strong negative-alignment structural strike: high energy, high theme, very strong magnitude, and low ambiguity. It reads like one of the first chapters where both halves of the double novel fail in the same meaningful way.
Revision instruction: Preserve the chapter's twin-collapse design, but ensure cause-and-effect is crisp so this feels like earned consequence, not just stacked humiliation.

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Reason: One of the best descent chapters in the manuscript: high energy, strong gravity, very strong premise force, and comparatively low cheapness. This is a real institutional reckoning, not filler conflict.
Revision instruction: Give this chapter cleaner payoff links to prior workplace pressures and stronger downstream consequences into the next 2-4 chapters.

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Reason: Katiya's origin trauma chapter has high gravity, high premise load, and meaningful magnitude. It seems to explain the emotional architecture the climax later pays off.

Revision instruction: Protect its essential revelations, but integrate it so it lands as structural necessity rather than inserted backstory; trim any explanatory excess around the core wound.

Ch 45 — In Future Grief

Reason: This is one of the healthiest bridge chapters in the ascent: both protagonists face family pressure while theme and positive magnitude stay strong.
Revision instruction: Keep the bilateral family pressure, but make the mirrored scenes asymmetrical in texture and stakes so they feel complementary rather than duplicated.

Drag Corridors

Ch 2–9

Problem: opening repetition / premise under-acceleration | **Confidence:** 0.97
Reason: Act One has a dense cluster of very high cut-risk chapters (2,3,4,5,8,9) and multiple low-gravity, low-magnitude misunderstanding beats. The hook exists, but the opening spends too long re-explaining confusion, trauma baseline, and cross-door disorientation without enough new vector.
Suggested fix: Compress the early mirror loop. Merge or shorten repeated Cody/Katiya misunderstanding beats so each crossing changes the relationship or the rules. Make the opening answer a sharper question faster: why this door, why these two, and what pressure will force continued contact?

Ch 14–20

Problem: mid-Act Two diffusion | **Confidence:** 0.84
Reason: These chapters carry moderate-to-high cut risk and mostly weak-to-moderate magnitude. The material appears to broaden world/social texture, but premise movement is soft and the dual-protagonist mirroring risks producing pleasant but non-compounding scenes.
Suggested fix: Audit every scene in this corridor for net change. Combine orientation, open-house, training, and dating material so that each chapter advances one external complication and one internal contradiction, rather than offering parallel slices of life.

Ch 29–33

Problem: premise drift / tonal tourism | **Confidence:** 0.95
Reason: This is the clearest Act Three drag pocket. Chapters 29, 32, and 33 are among the highest cut-risk and cheap-action/drama entries, while 32 hits magnitude zero entirely. The Earth/fantasy novelty and relationship beats look entertaining but structurally slack.
Suggested fix: Compress this corridor hard. Keep only the moments that directly trigger the later collapses, institutional consequences, or emotional commitments. Any tourism, banter, or romantic beat must earn its place by setting up Chapters 34-38 or the climax.

Ch 40–44

Problem: late-build redundancy | **Confidence:** 0.79
Reason: Act Four is generally strong, but 40, 41, 43, and 44 show elevated cheapness/cut-risk relative to the surrounding endgame. These chapters seem to repeat planning, fabrication, alliance tension, grief

processing, and household pressure in slightly varied mirrored forms.
Suggested fix: Condense the run into fewer, sharper escalations. Each late-build chapter should do one irreplaceable thing: reveal capability, fracture alliance, deepen commitment, or trigger the next lock-in. Remove duplicated emotional processing.

Magnitude Turns

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Turn: major negative plunge
Reason: This is one of the strongest descent beats in the novel and a point where both protagonists' tracks appear to synchronize around failure.
Revision instruction: Strengthen setup in the preceding chapters so this collapse feels like the inevitable result of accumulated flaws, not an abrupt pile-on.

Ch 30 — Cold Sweat

Turn: deepening negative commitment
Reason: High theme plus strong negative magnitude suggests this is not just setback but premise-bearing deterioration.
Revision instruction: Clarify what specifically worsens here that cannot be unworsened, especially across both protagonists' mirrored tracks.

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Turn: institutional nadir
Reason: Very high negative premise force marks this as one of the most important collapse chapters on Cody's side.
Revision instruction: Make downstream fallout visible immediately after the chapter so readers feel the system closing, not just a dramatic scene ending.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Turn: sign change into recovery
Reason: This is the first clear positive-magnitude step after the Act Three descent, but its own chapter gravity and cut-risk suggest the turn may be underpowered or under-framed.
Revision instruction: Build the reversal more explicitly. Seed this chapter in prior despair and make the positive shift legible as a choice, discovery, or alliance, not a mood change.

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Turn: hinge / ambiguous pivot
Reason: Enormous energy and gravity with magnitude near zero means the chapter matters a lot but its directional meaning is unclear. It likely functions as an emotional hinge without enough vector definition.
Revision instruction: Decide whether this chapter is the end of descent, the cost of truth, or the beginning of action, and revise scene emphasis so readers can feel the directional turn.

Ch 38 — Bottoming Out

Turn: recovery consolidation
Reason: Positive magnitude after the hinge suggests this is where despair becomes direction, but cheap-drama flags indicate some of the pain may be overextended relative to premise movement.
Revision instruction: Trim any repetitive collapse language and emphasize the concrete new direction that distinguishes this from Chapter 37.

Ch 48 — Metanoia

Turn: late positive acceleration
Reason: Strong positive premise force and healthy theme indicate this is a crucial conversion chapter where both protagonists begin acting from earned truth.
Revision instruction: Increase the sense that this chapter cashes checks written earlier: callbacks, admissions, and choices should directly answer prior failures.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Turn: endgame lock-in
Reason: This is the cleanest positive turn before the climax, with excellent alignment and low ambiguity.
Revision instruction: Treat it as the final threshold. Tighten any transitional material so the chapter hits as the story officially becoming the story it promised.

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Turn: ultimate positive resolution
Reason: The manuscript's entire mountain resolves here; all metrics agree this is the chapter that matters most.
Revision instruction: Ensure the emotional, thematic, and tactical beats converge in the same sequence so the climax resolves character, relationship, and premise together.

Cheap Heat / Low-Premise Flags

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Issue: cheap drama / cheap action in early trauma baseline
Reason: Drama and action are loud for an early chapter, but theme and magnitude are not carrying the same weight. This can read as front-loaded suffering before readers are fully invested.
Revision instruction: Reduce repetitive nightmare intensity and redirect focus toward one or two concrete character-defining contradictions that will matter later.

Ch 23 — Failing To Launch

Issue: high-drama low-theme setback pileup
Reason: Very high cheap-drama and high cut risk suggest a chapter built from frustration beats that do not cohere strongly enough around the premise.

Revision instruction: Either upgrade the chapter's thematic clarity—what exact fear or flaw is being exposed?—or compress it into adjacent failure chapters.

Ch 29 — Once Lovers

Issue: loud but under-aligned relational material
Reason: Among the highest cheap-action and cheap-drama scores, with weak theme relative to intensity. The chapter likely contains motion and feeling without enough premise traction.
Revision instruction: Strip out any beat that is merely romantic complication or family warmth unless it directly sets up the later collapse or choice.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Issue: melodramatic/novelty detour with zero vector
Reason: Magnitude at 0.0 plus very high cheap drama and high cut risk marks this as the strongest premise-vacuum in the manuscript.
Revision instruction: Rebuild the chapter around one consequential discovery or decision; otherwise compress it drastically or merge its useful parts elsewhere.

Ch 41 — Annealment

Issue: late-stage cheap action and cheap drama
Reason: In the approach to climax, this chapter is doing a lot of labor/tension material with very low theme for its level of noise.
Revision instruction: Make the rebuilding/deception beats explicitly about the story's core argument—truth, trust, courage, chosen action—or cut them down.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory

Issue: emotionally sincere but somewhat melodramatic
Reason: Cheap-drama is high even though the chapter has real human content. It may be processing grief one beat longer than the structure can support this late.
Revision instruction: Keep the communal-grief function, but shorten mourning repetitions and sharpen what changes because of the grief.

Ch 46 — Close Quarters

Issue: romance-pressure blend not fully aligned
Reason: High energy and gravity are real, but cheap-action and cheap-drama remain elevated, suggesting some vow/confession material may be leaning on intensity more than vector.
Revision instruction: Clarify what this chapter commits the protagonists to do next. The confession should alter tactics or stakes, not just deepen feeling.

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Issue: spectacle risk in the battle setup
Reason: High action with notable cheap-action score implies some battle business may be louder than it is thematically precise, especially next to the much stronger Chapter 51.

Revision instruction: Refocus battle beats on Katiya's nightmare pattern, Cody's choice, and the misdirected defense logic so the action is all setup for the true climax.

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

Issue: bonus-epilogue cheap heat / low integration
Reason: Extremely high cut risk, very low gravity, high cheap drama, and placement after emotional closure make this feel detachable. Given your note, it behaves like promo add-on material, not structural necessity.
Revision instruction: Label and position it as explicit bonus material, or seed Titus/Ellie earlier and tie the reveal to the main novel's thematic argument so it stops feeling appended.

Cut Candidates

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

Action: trim
Reason: High cut risk and low gravity in an opening already carrying two-protagonist setup load. Likely useful world/character texture, but not enough movement.
Target: Condense tavern/introduction material to the minimum needed to define Katiya's baseline, Aldrin/Jullian context, and emotional unrest.

Ch 3 — The Day After

Action: compress_hard
Reason: Low gravity, high ambiguity, high cut risk. Cody's office malaise may be over-explained early.
Target: Fold key workplace humiliation and Miguel setup into neighboring chapters so the opening gets to the door-premise faster.

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Action: trim
Reason: High cheapness and cut risk despite useful trauma baseline.
Target: Shorten nightmare/routine material; keep only details that pay off in Katiya's climax or key relationships.

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

Action: compress_hard
Reason: Very high cut risk and cheap drama; likely atmosphere and friendship texture more than structural movement.
Target: Reduce drinking/bro hang content unless a specific line or choice becomes crucial later.

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

Action: merge
Reason: A repeat misunderstanding/fight beat in an opening already containing multiple such beats.

Target: Merge with adjacent crossing/conflict material so the early loop escalates instead of reiterates.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

Action: compress_hard
Reason: One of the highest cut-risk chapters in the book; low gravity and weak alignment.
Target: Keep only the Reed introduction and the fact that Cody tries denial; remove repeated rationalization beats.

Ch 12 — Anxiety and Avoidance

Action: merge
Reason: High cut risk, low gravity, and another time-skip adjustment chapter.
Target: Integrate Bertram-rescue/blame fallout into a stronger chapter centered on Katiya's isolation and need for Cody.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Action: trim
Reason: High cut risk and low prominence; may restate Cody's ennui without enough escalation.
Target: Condense workplace routine and nostalgia into a shorter bridge with one strong Jackson/father beat.

Ch 23 — Failing To Launch

Action: merge
Reason: High cheapness and cut risk suggest partial redundancy with 24's stronger collapse.
Target: Move only the necessary setup beats into 24 and let Friendly Fire carry the real failure sequence.

Ch 29 — Once Lovers

Action: compress_hard
Reason: Very high cheap-action/cheap-drama and high cut risk in a drag corridor.
Target: Cut relational/family beats that do not directly precipitate 30-35 or redefine Katiya's stakes.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Action: compress_hard
Reason: Magnitude zero, high cut risk, and top-tier cheap drama make this the easiest structural compression target.
Target: Excise novelty-tourism and retain only the one or two revelations needed for subsequent plot and relationship movement.

Ch 33 — Modern Fantasy

Action: merge
Reason: High cheap action, high cut risk, and adjacent to another drift chapter.

Target: Combine with 32 or refocus into a single chapter that moves from brief levity straight into bad news and consequence.

Ch 40 — Reaching Up

Action: trim
Reason: Late planning chapter with elevated cut risk in a section that can easily overrepeat team-building.
Target: Remove redundant planning banter and keep only the decisions, alliances, and project commitments that alter the endgame.

Ch 41 — Annealment

Action: differentiate
Reason: Extremely high cheap-action/cheap-drama for a late-stage chapter.
Target: Make Cody's build line and Katiya's house-pressure line less mirror-similar; each should solve a different structural problem.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory

Action: trim
Reason: Moderate-to-high cut risk and high cheap drama late in the build.
Target: Shorten grief/intimacy repetition while preserving the chapter's function of communalizing loss.

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

Action: keep
Reason: By far the highest cut risk in the book; clearly behaves like an attached teaser rather than necessary closure.
Target: Keep only if explicitly framed as bonus/promotional material. If treated as part of the novel proper, it needs major integration work.

Chapter-by-Chapter Notes

Ch 1 — Strangers To Enemies 1

Assessment: Strong hook chapter: it introduces the door-premise fast and gives Cody a clear emotional vacancy for the story to invade.
Revision note: Clarify the vector of the opening wonder/disorientation so the scene promises more than novelty; signal earlier what this story will demand from Cody.

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

Assessment: Useful Katiya baseline and social context for the mirrored structure.
Revision note: Cut to the pressure point sooner; reduce atmospheric setup that delays the actual collision with the premise.

Ch 3 — The Day After

Assessment: It broadens Cody's ordinary-world dissatisfaction and workplace friction.
Revision note: Strip this to the indispensable Reed/workplace beats because the chapter currently spends more time proving ennui than escalating plot.

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Assessment: It establishes Katiya's trauma pattern and her habit of self-management, both important for the climax.
Revision note: Dial back the suffering-on-arrival effect and emphasize the specific wound patterns that will recur in later high-gravity chapters.

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

Assessment: The Miguel friendship gives Cody social texture and a lived-in life outside the gimmick.
Revision note: Shorten the hangout material aggressively unless each exchange is seeding a later payoff in Cody's loyalty, shame, or decision-making.

Ch 6 — Insurgency

Assessment: This chapter gives Katiya an external disturbance that pushes her toward the first real collision with Cody.
Revision note: Make the causal chain from distant threat to home intrusion cleaner so the chapter feels less like stacked incidents and more like a single rising turn.

Ch 7 — Exfiltration

Assessment: The mirrored re-seeing of the crossing supports the double-novel design.
Revision note: Differentiate Katiya's perception enough that this does more than replay Chapter 1; it should revise our understanding, not merely duplicate it.

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

Assessment: It keeps the mutual fear and misread motives alive.
Revision note: This is one misunderstanding clash too many in close sequence; merge or shorten so each confrontation changes the rules.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

Assessment: Reed's introduction matters for Cody's long institutional arc.
Revision note: Prune the denial-and-barricade repetition and move to the workplace consequence faster.

Ch 10 — Strategic Retreat

Assessment: This is one of the first chapters where Katiya's personal instability turns into public cost.
Revision note: Smooth the time-skip handling and tie the panic, reprimand, and Bertram-search into one coherent line of consequence.

Ch 11 — Ennui and Excoriation

Assessment: It reinforces Cody's stagnation and sets up the cry through the door as a meaningful call to action.
Revision note: Trim workplace repetition so the chapter lands on the summons rather than the routine.

Ch 12 — Anxiety and Avoidance

Assessment: Katiya's isolation sharpens and the Bertram crisis raises her desperation.
Revision note: Merge this with adjacent material so the rescue/blame fallout becomes propulsion instead of another pause-and-redirect chapter.

Ch 13 — The Sleeping Knight

Assessment: This is an effective intimacy-and-rules chapter that makes the bond plausible.
Revision note: Keep the vulnerable contact, but sharpen the mutual contradiction in the 'no interfering' agreement so it reads as character truth, not rom-com scaffolding.

Ch 14 — Luddite By Chance

Assessment: Katiya's culture shock gives the cross-world premise concrete texture.
Revision note: Watch the charm-to-drag ratio; keep only the future-shock beats that deepen her character or alter the relationship dynamic.

Ch 15 — Technophile By Choice

Assessment: It usefully inverts the previous chapter by letting Cody inhabit Katiya's world.
Revision note: Tighten the social-tour material and preserve only the moments that complicate belonging, jealousy, or status.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Assessment: The Alan/Jackson material supports Cody's grief spine.
Revision note: Compress the office return so the father/brother emotional content carries more relative weight.

Ch 17 — Onward To Chaos

Assessment: This chapter gives Katiya active competence, duty, and a growing tangle of promises.
Revision note: Highlight which promise or pursuit here will matter later; don't let the chapter read as episodic competence display.

Ch 18 — Civillian Combat

Assessment: Cody's training day usefully shows his willingness to engage Katiya's world rather than merely visit it.

Revision note: Clarify the long-term significance of Aldrin noticing him so the chapter's character beat also has structural consequence.

Ch 19 — Warrior Business

Assessment: It opens Cody's workplace world to Katiya and broadens the social network around him.
Revision note: Reduce observational social texture unless it sharpens Cody's exclusion or Katiya's perception of his stalled life.

Ch 20 — Domestic Relations

Assessment: The parallel dating material advances the theme of mutual misrecognition and emotional displacement.
Revision note: Differentiate the two halves more sharply so the chapter feels like a comparison with purpose, not double coverage of awkwardness.

Ch 21 — Foreign Affairs

Assessment: This chapter turns relationship unease into revealing discomfort and bad choices.
Revision note: Aim the intercutting toward one shared thematic claim about substitution, avoidance, or emotional dishonesty.

Ch 22 — Losing To Fear

Assessment: It effectively sets up competitive and professional pressure on both sides of the door.
Revision note: Tighten the test/prep material so the chapter's function is clear: this is a runway for failure, not another broad sampling of routine.

Ch 23 — Failing To Launch

Assessment: It contributes the sense of plans buckling under pressure across both protagonists.
Revision note: Most of this chapter is overshadowed by the stronger collapse in 24; salvage only the setup that 24 truly needs.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Assessment: A major twin-failure chapter that sharply aligns the double-novel structure with the book's actual premise.
Revision note: Make the parallel failures echo by logic rather than by simple simultaneity; the deeper the shared flaw, the stronger this lands.

Ch 25 — A House Divided

Assessment: The domestic blowup gives emotional consequence to the prior public failures.
Revision note: Be careful not to let the argument become generic couple combustion; every line should expose the fear structures driving both of them.

Ch 26 — Cold War

Assessment: This flashback has real mass and appears central to Cody's grief architecture.
Revision note: Frame it with especially clear entry and exit logic so it deepens the present arc instead of feeling like a temporary genre switch.

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Assessment: A foundational trauma chapter that appears essential to understanding Katiya's entire behavior pattern.
Revision note: Refine for precision and image retention; the goal is memorable emotional architecture, not maximal backstory volume.

Ch 28 — Prometheus

Assessment: It gives Cody a believable spark of renewed competence and a path toward the project line.
Revision note: Make the late-night idea feel more causally fused to his grief and identity, not just to plot convenience.

Ch 29 — Once Lovers

Assessment: It supplies relational and family pressure around Katiya at a vulnerable stage.
Revision note: Cut any beat that does not directly intensify the later collapse, choice, or loyalty conflict.

Ch 30 — Cold Sweat

Assessment: This chapter seems to fuse alliance-building with looming external/institutional threat in a premise-relevant way.
Revision note: Clarify the symmetry between Katiya's new alliances and Cody's ominous email so the chapter reads as one tightening vice.

Ch 31 — Heating Up

Assessment: It helps drag the protagonists back into contact with urgency and physical consequence.
Revision note: Because magnitude is near zero, clarify what direction the chapter turns the story—reunion, rescue, relapse, or commitment.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Assessment: There is probably some needed decompression and wonder here after heavy material.
Revision note: Right now it looks structurally optional; either give it one decisive reveal or strip it to a brief transition.

Ch 33 — Modern Fantasy

Assessment: It appears to provide one last moment of buoyancy before the next bad turn.

Revision note: Merge the levity with the incoming bad news so the chapter becomes whiplash with purpose rather than another excursion.

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Assessment: A real structural blow that advances Cody's institutional and personal arc with force.
Revision note: Strengthen continuity from earlier workplace chapters so this feels like culmination, not sudden severity.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Assessment: This is a powerful companion collapse on Katiya's side and one of the novel's true mountains.
Revision note: Sharpen the specific way this chapter injures or transforms her position so the aftermath chapters can build from a clean wound.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Assessment: It offers the first glimmer of recovery and renewed care after the double collapse.
Revision note: The chapter needs a more legible reversal engine; identify the exact act of kindness, discovery, or resolve that turns the vector positive.

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Assessment: Immense emotional and thematic weight makes this an essential hinge chapter.
Revision note: Its direction is too ambiguous; revise the emphasis so readers understand what is ending here and what is beginning.

Ch 38 — Bottoming Out

Assessment: It converts shared damage into mutual visibility and gives despair practical shape.
Revision note: Trim repeated anguish and push harder on the new deadline, plan, or obligation created by the chapter.

Ch 39 — Crossing Over

Assessment: The widening of the private story into larger war stakes is valuable and timely.
Revision note: Titus/Sylvia's arrival needs crisp integration so the chapter feels like escalation, not a fresh book being introduced.

Ch 40 — Reaching Up

Assessment: It begins the team-build/planning mode and usefully merges the two worlds into a shared strategic space.
Revision note: Condense the social-planning overlap; late in the novel, every page should either harden the plan or complicate it.

Ch 41 — Annealment
Assessment: It keeps both protagonists active under pressure rather than static in grief.
Revision note: The mirrored labor-and-household stress needs stronger contrast in dramatic function; make one about capability and the other about moral risk.

Ch 42 — Eutectic Point
Assessment: This chapter broadens the political and practical frame of the endgame in a useful way.
Revision note: Because it is an information-bearing chapter, be ruthless about making every new ally, tool, and warning alter later choices.

Ch 43 — Harsh Noise
Assessment: It advances hope through fabrication while showing that alliance-building remains unstable.
Revision note: Reduce generalized tension and make the chapter pivot on one decisive misunderstanding or breakthrough instead of several medium-intensity frictions.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory
Assessment: Communal grief and earned intimacy both matter here, and the chapter humanizes the war effort.
Revision note: Shorten the mourning passages until the chapter's real outcome—changed trust and commitment—stands in the foreground.

Ch 45 — In Future Grief
Assessment: A strong bilateral family-pressure chapter that deepens the stakes without stalling momentum.
Revision note: Keep the parallel structure, but avoid scene-mirroring so exact that one side feels like the other's echo.

Ch 46 — Close Quarters
Assessment: This chapter effectively turns calm-before-the-storm space into emotional and tactical commitment.
Revision note: Make the confession/vow alter concrete endgame behavior so the chapter earns its high intensity structurally.

Ch 47 — Ground Control
Assessment: The institutional lockdown of both protagonists is a strong pre-endgame squeeze.
Revision note: Increase the sense of simultaneity and trapped momentum so this reads as a synchronized clamp rather than two adjacent inconveniences.

Ch 48 — Metanoia

Assessment: A highly effective conversion chapter where both protagonists begin acting from earned truth.
Revision note: Lean into callback structure; let specific prior lies, evasions, and failures be answered explicitly here.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Assessment: This is the novel fully becoming itself, with strong premise alignment and decisive mobilization.
Revision note: Tighten transitions and exposition so nothing blunts the threshold-crossing power of the chapter.

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Assessment: It provides necessary tactical escalation and puts Cody and Katiya under the exact conditions the climax needs.
Revision note: Trim any battle logistics that do not directly set up Katiya's nightmare confrontation or Cody's crucial act of disobedience.

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Assessment: The book's true climax and best chapter by every relevant structural measure.
Revision note: Revise around setup/payoff integrity only; do not overstuff aftermath or explanation into the chapter and risk diluting its clarity.

Ch 52 — Parasmagate

Assessment: This gives the main emotional closure the novel needs after the summit.
Revision note: Because its magnitude softens after the climax, keep it clean and brief; closure should feel settled, not re-litigated.

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

Assessment: As a bonus sting, it may have intrigue value and sequel/promo utility.
Revision note: Do not ask it to function as core epilogue unless you integrate Titus materially earlier; otherwise label it clearly as bonus content and let the main novel end on 52.

Next Revision Pass

- Compress the opening misunderstanding loop so Chapters 1-12 produce faster premise acceleration and fewer repeated Cody/Katiya mirror beats.
- Identify the indispensable spine of Act Two and merge weak bridge chapters into stronger failure chapters, especially around 23-25.
- Aggressively compress or rebuild the 29-33 corridor so entertainment/novelty material directly sets up the double collapse in 34-35.
- Clarify the major vector hinge across 36-38, especially Chapter 37, so the reader can feel the story turning from descent into directed action.

- In Act Four, reduce duplicated planning, grief-processing, and household-pressure scenes; each chapter should own one unique endgame function.
- Differentiate mirrored dual-protagonist scenes more sharply: if Cody and Katiya are reflecting each other, the reflection must produce contrast or escalation, not repetition.
- Strengthen setup/payoff chains into 24, 34, 35, 49, and 51 so the biggest magnitude turns feel causally inevitable.
- Audit every high cheap-action/high cheap-drama chapter and either increase thematic precision or cut surface intensity.
- Protect and refine the true core mountain: 24, 27, 34, 35, 37, 45, 48, 49, 51.
- Decide formally whether Chapter 53 is part of the novel or a promotional bonus; revise its framing accordingly.

Full Chapter / Unit Table

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
1	Strangers To Enemies 1	4.9	5.1	7.7	-0.09	17.7	-0.7	35.6	42.7	Cody	Cody celebrates his first home, drunkenly stumbles through the adjoining door into another world, is healed by strangers, and fixates on the "cosplayer" girl on the other side.
2	The Knight Before	2.3	5.4	5.7	+0.07	13.4	+0.4	11.2	80.2	Katiya	Katiya's intro: she struggles to relax, Aldrin frames trainee expectations, and she reconnects with Jullian as they "christen" her new place.
3	The Day After	3.8	5.8	5.2	+0.03	14.8	+0.2	8.8	82.7	Cody	Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.
4	Secondhand Cottage	5.5	7.1	4.5	-0.10	17.2	-0.5	15.8	82.1	Katiya	Katiya's trauma baseline: nightmares of Hillfar; she self-stabilizes, starts her day, meets Derry & Carmen (Rayna foreshadow), and heads to base with Bertram.
5	Firsthand Home	2.6	6.8	5.1	-0.05	14.5	-0.2	10.2	84.9	Cody	Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.
6	Insurgency	5.4	6.7	5.8	-0.14	17.9	-0.8	22.9	67.2	Katiya	Katiya's first day ends in panic when a distant light (Firebrand tie-in) appears; town responds; on returning home she finds an intruder—Cody— ambushes him.
7	Exfiltration	4.6	5.0	6.0	-0.06	15.6	-0.4	12.4	72.2	Katiya	Prologue re-seen through Katiya: she crosses into the modern world and recoils, landing back through the door—mirror of Cody's intro.
8	Strangers To Enemies 2	5.7	3.3	5.0	-0.10	14.0	-0.5	6.7	88.4	Katiya	Third clash: Katiya (assuming Auvryan

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											assassin) and Cody fight to another misunderstanding; she drives him back through the door.
9	Surprise Approach	4.5	4.4	4.8	-0.07	13.7	-0.3	8.3	89.6	Cody	Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.
10	Strategic Retreat	5.9	8.4	6.1	-0.46	20.4	-2.8	34.7	54.4	Katiya	Katiya cleans to stave off panic, studies Cody's device; time skip: a month later she hesitates during a royal escort, barely averts disaster, is berated, and runs to find Bertram.
11	Ennui and Excoriation	3.9	6.5	6.4	-0.18	16.8	-1.1	25.4	63.0	Cody	Another month later: Cody is bored while Reed earns praise; Nav spins up a new project; Cody ghosts social invites, but hears pleading through the door at home.
12	Anxiety and Avoidance	3.6	3.9	5.3	-0.09	12.8	-0.5	11.2	85.8	Katiya	FOUR WEEK TIME SKIPKatiya, Ryder, and Paxton rescue near-dead Bertram; she's blamed and shut out—her only remaining lifeline is Cody.
13	The Sleeping Knight	5.1	7.2	6.2	-0.55	18.6	-3.4	28.8	59.4	Cody, Katiya	Katiya crosses mid-panic; Cody calms her and lets her sleep; awkward breakfast; they agree to "no interfering" (both intend to break it).
14	Luddite By Chance	4.3	4.8	6.2	-0.37	15.4	-2.3	16.6	69.0	Cody, Katiya	Cody gives her a gentle orientation day: first car ride (terrifying), Costco errand gauntlet—Katiya is overwhelmed by the future.
15	Technophile By Choice	4.3	5.8	5.7	-0.17	15.8	-1.0	19.3	73.6	Cody, Katiya	Cody runs Katiya's route in Gaffesend; she tours him as "royal inventor"; awkward Jullian moment; tavern hang where Cody fits in.
16	Back To Business	3.4	5.2	5.3	-0.18	13.9	-1.0	13.2	82.3	Cody	Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											returns hoping for an open door.
17	Onward To Chaos	6.3	6.0	6.8	-0.37	19.2	-2.5	34.1	51.1	Katiya	Katiya visits Bertram in the hospital (promises Hillfar); market duty goes sideways; she chases and collars Rayna (Ahkvasan half-blood); Jullian downplays her leap; Cody leaves a treat.
18	Civillian Combat	4.7	5.5	6.1	-0.01	16.3	-0.1	24.0	66.8	Cody	Cody's volunteer training day: Katiya teases, his mistake catches Aldrin's eye; later he chooses friendship over victory in a challenge—character beat.
19	Warrior Business	3.9	5.2	6.0	-0.17	15.0	-1.0	20.4	73.0	Katiya	Open house at Cody's work: meet Reed & Kei; Cody geeks out, Katiya meets Alan & Kim; they overhear Reed/Kei on Cody missing from the "Future Talent" wall.
20	Domestic Relations	4.1	6.3	5.6	-0.26	16.0	-1.5	24.0	72.6	Cody, Katiya	Katiya engineers a Cody—Kei date; in parallel she and Jullian go to hot springs and bristle; Cody's date feels off and foggy—he insists he's "fine."
21	Foreign Affairs	4.9	7.4	6.5	-0.35	18.9	-2.3	35.9	54.0	Katiya, Cody	Katiya extracts an uncomfortable truth from Jullian; intercut meltdown date beats (both couples misfire); Cody & Kei hook up but it lands as empty.
22	Losing To Fear	4.1	6.5	6.4	-0.44	17.0	-2.8	35.0	60.6	Katiya, Cody	Katiya passes core exams but shoots poorly; Aryn is unflappable; Cody and Reed clash about what a Level-1 is; Katiya insists on leading the next team exam, feeling off her game.
23	Failing To Launch	4.8	6.7	4.6	-0.28	16.1	-1.3	38.5	78.5	Cody, Katiya	Cody presents and gets hammered; Reed's allies redirect the room; Katiya's plan withers,

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											Bertram is "killed" in exercise, she barges the opposing house—bad optics.
24	Friendly Fire	7.8	7.2	8.0	-0.80	23.0	-6.4	73.9	22.2	Cody, Katiya	Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.
25	A House Divided	6.3	7.6	7.1	-0.71	21.0	-5.1	78.0	32.9	Cody, Katiya	Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.
26	Cold War	8.6	7.4	7.5	-0.23	23.4	-1.7	90.3	20.9	Cody	Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.
27	Warm Solitude	7.3	7.6	7.8	-0.61	22.8	-4.8	79.8	21.8	Katiya	Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.
28	Prometheus	6.1	6.0	6.6	-0.50	18.8	-3.3	57.1	49.0	Cody	Months later: Naveen notes Cody's improvement but deeper ennui; company lunch where Reed is promoted; Reed asks Cody to help fix his flawed prototype (they bond); that night Cody, riding the high, uses Essence as flux—batteries "fire" and spark his next idea.
29	Once Lovers	6.5	6.0	4.6	-0.36	17.1	-1.6	43.4	74.9	Katiya, Cody	
30	Cold Sweat	4.6	6.4	8.3	-0.67	19.3	-5.6	46.7	33.8	Katiya, Cody	
31	Heating Up	5.8	5.5	6.8	-0.06	18.2	-0.4	37.1	52.5	Katiya, Cody	
32	Fantastic Modernity	4.0	6.4	4.6	+0.00	14.9	+0.0	25.7	85.1	Katiya, Cody	

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33	Modern Fantasy	6.1	4.6	5.5	-0.17	16.2	-0.9	36.6	70.2	Cody, Katiya	
34	Professional Death	6.8	8.0	8.0	-0.80	22.9	-6.5	67.4	22.4	Cody	
35	Physical Demise	7.3	8.4	7.2	-0.72	22.9	-5.1	75.4	29.3	Katiya	
36	Holding On	4.6	5.1	5.3	+0.11	15.1	+0.6	49.0	70.8	Cody	
37	Letting Go	6.1	9.2	8.8	-0.02	24.1	-0.2	80.1	10.9	Katiya, Cody	
38	Bottoming Out	5.7	7.4	6.0	+0.19	19.1	+1.2	60.5	51.1	Cody, Katiya	After reaching the ugliest versions of themselves, Cody and Katiya finally stop performing strength and let each other see the damage. Cody interrupts his own collapse long enough to comfort Katiya after Bertram's death, and Katiya's tribunal summons turns grief into a hard deadline. By the end of the chapter, despair has not lifted—but it has been given direction.
39	Crossing Over	6.8	7.9	7.0	+0.21	21.7	+1.5	65.8	36.7	Cody, Katiya	The private crisis inside Katiya's house becomes part of a much larger war when Titus and Sylvia force their way into the story. Cody is thrown into a terrifying first encounter with people from a harsher world, Katiya begins to understand the scale of what is coming, and Cody's attempt to regroup turns into a brutal training date that recommits him to fighting for a future instead of grieving one he already lost.
40	Reaching Up	5.7	6.1	5.9	+0.34	17.6	+2.0	43.0	62.4	Katiya, Cody	The planning phase begins in earnest as Cody's world and Katiya's world stop operating like separate emotional shelters. Over coffee, cheap drinks, and overlapping stories, the group starts building a shared strategy. Cody's abandoned project stops being a joke, and Katiya's

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											increasingly unstable home life collides with the possibility that her estranged allies might actually stand with her.
41	Annealment	6.7	7.2	4.6	+0.16	18.5	+0.7	42.9	72.3	Cody, Katiya	Action replaces vague intention. Cody begins rebuilding JAX with help instead of shame, while Katiya tries to hold together a house full of secrets, fugitives, and divided loyalties. Both storylines harden under pressure: Cody through labor, Katiya through deception and risk.
42	Eutectic Point	5.7	5.7	7.0	+0.43	18.4	+3.0	42.0	50.4	Katiya, Cody	The story widens. Katiya is introduced to Aliaki, Jade, and the deeper political reality behind the coming attack, while Cody is invited deeper into Reed's privileged world and closer to a genuine second chance at proving himself. Both protagonists are handed tools and warnings they only partly understand.
43	Harsh Noise	5.7	7.6	6.0	+0.35	19.3	+2.1	49.1	55.6	Cody, Katiya	Hope starts making noise. Cody begins fabrication in Reed's family machine space and gains the first meaningful encouragement he has felt from adults tied to the aerospace legacy he still wants. Meanwhile, Katiya's alliance nearly implodes in a misunderstanding fueled by power and distrust, forcing her to stabilize a group that could either save Gaffesend or tear itself apart.
44	In Loving Memory	5.0	7.7	5.4	+0.37	18.0	+2.0	50.6	63.5	Cody, Katiya	Grief finally becomes communal instead of private. Cody helps Aryn and Rayna speak through loss by talking about Jackson, Katiya returns to a quieter house and finds evidence of the care he has

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											extended to others, and the chapter ends with intimacy growing out of exhaustion, trust, and shared mourning.
45	In Future Grief	6.3	7.9	7.7	+0.54	21.8	+4.1	68.4	29.4	Cody, Katiya	Both protagonists face family systems that love them but do not really understand what they are choosing. Cody confronts his parents' fear, finances, and assumptions about his future, while Katiya tells her family the truth about the danger she still intends to face. Jackson's name and memory become fused to Cody's project, turning invention into memorial.
46	Close Quarters	7.0	8.5	6.5	+0.42	22.0	+2.7	71.2	38.7	Katiya	The quiet before the storm turns out not to be quiet at all. Cody and Katiya field-test the prototype and accidentally unleash terrifying power, then return home to find official pressure closing around Katiya's life. Their last stretch of peace becomes a vow, a confession, and an act of choosing each other before the worlds move to tear them apart.
47	Ground Control	5.9	6.1	6.6	+0.27	18.7	+1.8	63.1	47.2	Cody, Katiya	Cody and Katiya each step into what should be their final chance to claim the futures they want, only to be immediately restrained by the institutions they have spent the story trying to survive. Cody tries to reach the Aspen conference room before HR can bury him, while Katiya is taken into custody before her tribunal and shut away from the threat she knows is coming. By the end of the chapter, both are trapped inside systems that mistake control for safety.

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48	Metanoia	6.0	6.9	7.3	+0.69	20.3	+5.0	69.4	35.3	Cody, Katiya	Both protagonists fight for one clean chance to be heard. Cody's confession turns his firing into a political problem inside Navidson-Monroe, while Katiya persuades Aryn that the truth matters more than procedure and turns imprisonment into a joint push toward Aldrin. The chapter tests what they have actually learned: not how to escape pressure, but how to move through it without lying to themselves.
49	Paragate	6.4	6.9	8.6	+0.85	21.9	+7.3	82.0	17.2	Katiya, Cody	The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.
50	Knightfall	7.7	6.3	6.5	+0.58	20.5	+3.8	80.1	38.2	Cody, Katiya	The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.
51	Daybreak	8.1	8.9	9.0	+0.90	26.0	+8.1	91.4	0.0	Katiya	Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.
52	Parasmagate	3.0	6.8	7.5	+0.32	17.3	+2.4	42.4	48.7	Cody, Default	The epilogue gives Paragate its emotional closure before leaving one quiet fracture open for the future. Cody and Katiya emerge from the battle changed, no longer using each other's worlds as refuge from their own lives, and their relationship finally rests on chosen commitment instead of mutual escape.
53	Threaded Echoes	2.6	5.8	4.6	+0.40	13.0	+1.8	5.4	99.9	Default	